

Vasili Diakonov

Senior Product Designer

Portfolio: <https://vasiliidiakonov.github.io/website>

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Location: London, UK

Summary

Senior Product Designer with 6+ years designing and shipping mobile and cross-platform products across iOS, Android, web, and desktop. Led end to end design initiatives that improved Day 1 retention by 1.8%, increased referrals 3.4x, and raised marketing conversion from 20% to 30%. Open-minded and collaborative, eager to learn from feedback and iterate on designs. Create collaborative environments between design, engineering, and product teams to ship features quickly while maintaining quality. Experienced with user research, design systems, analytics (Amplitude), and cross functional collaboration.

Skills

Hard Skills and Tools: Mobile Design (iOS/Android), UX/UI, Design Systems, Prototyping, User Research, Interaction Design, Information Architecture, Accessibility, PRD, Roadmapping, Material Design, Apple HIG, Figma (Auto Layout, Variables, Components), Lottie, Amplitude, Google Docs, JavaScript, Python, HTML/CSS, Data Driven Design, A/B Testing, Design Thinking, Agile/Lean UX, RICE Prioritization, JBTD

Soft Skills: Strategic Thinking, Stakeholder Management, Cross Functional Collaboration, Problem Solving, Data Driven Decision Making, Adaptability, Communication, Prioritization, Velocity & Execution, Advocacy

Professional Experience

Product Designer

November 2023 – November 2025

Aloha Browser

- Led select iOS/Android design initiatives for a privacy-focused browser startup in a three person design team, shipped improvements end to end that lifted Day 1 retention by 1.2% (iOS) and 0.6% (Android), contributed to retention of 50–70K users.
- Balanced modern B2C engagement patterns with restraint, applying gamification principles that motivated user behavior while maintaining focus on core privacy-first product values.
- Owned parts of end-to-end design across Android, iOS, Windows, and macOS from discovery to release, partnered with engineering, product, and company leadership to design 2+ features weekly.
- Redesigned the referral system, streamlined flows and elevated discoverability to drive a 3.4x increase in monthly referrals.
- Redesigned the marketing website using data-driven UX optimizations, increased conversion from 20% to 30% as part of a four person marketing team.
- Built and evolved a website design system, reduced design-to-development time by 50% and improved cross-platform consistency.
- Contributed competitive analysis and user research to inform product roadmaps and PRDs as part of four person discovery team.
- Presented strategic recommendations to CEO and engineering leads, secured buy in for major initiatives including tab management redesign.
- Rapidly explored 5+ design concepts per feature, iterating through multiple approaches before validation, enabling data-informed decisions on optimal solutions.
- Advocated for design quality in product discussions and proposed data driven alternatives when requests risked user outcomes or unnecessary complexity.
- Used customer insights to refine and advance design direction.
- Applied Amplitude analytics and user feedback to inform decisions and validate solutions pre and post release.
- Contributed to company growth from 3M to 5M+ MAU.

Freelance UI and Product Designer

May 2018 – November 2023

Various Clients

- Managed client relationships and project scopes independently, presented work directly to Founders and other senior level stakeholders.
- Designed and delivered UI and branding for B2C/B2B clients informed by brand strategy and market research.
- Led discovery workshops and stakeholder sessions to define problems and align on user centered solutions.
- Created design systems and brand guidelines to ensure consistency across touchpoints.

Visiting Lecturer

January 2021 – July 2022

British Higher School of Art and Design

- Lectured on creative coding, UI design, and web development, developed syllabi, led student critiques and mentored students to get desired results.

Design Intern

July – August 2019

Landor

- Developed generative software prototypes for clients such as Sberbank delivered presentations on research and design process.

Achievements

- Improved Day 1 retention by 1–1.5% on iOS/Android
- Increased marketing site conversion from 20% to 30%
- Raised referral program conversion 3.4x

Education

- University of Hertfordshire BA (Hons.) Graphic Design, First class, 2020

Languages

- English
- Russian